



Matthias Florian Sahli

Postdoctoral Researcher

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● SUMMARY

I am a postdoctoral researcher at the Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH) Business School, and was previously a researcher at the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) of the United Nations. I received my PhD in Economics from the University of Neuchâtel in 2023. My research focuses on the economics of intellectual property, innovation, digitization, sustainability and the creative industries. The goal of my work is to provide solid empirical evidence that supports current policy discussions. To do this, I invest considerable time and creativity in developing new datasets and conducting rigorous econometric analyses.

● ACADEMIC POSITIONS

- 2024 - present** **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)** · Business School, Bern, Switzerland
Postdoctoral Researcher
- 2019 - 2024** **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)** · Department for Economics and
Data Analytics, Geneva, Switzerland
PhD Research Fellow (2019–2023), then Postdoctoral Research Fellow (2023–2024)

● EDUCATION

- 2019 - 2023** **University of Neuchâtel** · Neuchâtel, Switzerland
PhD in Economics
- 2016 - 2019** **University of Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
MSc in Economics
- 2012 - 2016** **University of Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
BSc in Economics, minor in Political Sciences
- 2006 - 2011** **Gymnasium Hofwil & Schule für Gestaltung Bern** · Münchenbuchsee, Switzerland
Matura; talent promotion class in fine arts

VISITING

- 2020** **Copenhagen Business School (CBS)** · Copenhagen, Denmark
Visiting student
- 2020** **University of Southern Denmark (SDU)** · Odense, Denmark
Visiting student
- 2017** **École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL)** · Lausanne, Switzerland
Visiting student

● FURTHER POSITIONS

- 2017 - 2019** **Swiss Federal Institute of Intellectual Property (IPI)** · Bern, Switzerland
Internship (2017–2018), then Junior Economist, Office of the Chief Economist (2018–2019)
- 2013 - 2019** **Velokurier Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
Bike messenger; member of the cooperative (passive member since)
- 2011 - 2012** **Stiftung RGZ** · Zurich, Switzerland
Community service, school for people with multiple disabilities

● RESEARCH

13 publications & papers	66 citations	4 h-index	6 peer-reviewed venues
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Source: Google Scholar, retrieved 2026-08-07.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- **Digital Reuse and Online Availability of Visual Artworks**
M. Sahli, A. Cuntz & P. J. Heald · *Information Economics and Policy* · 2026 · **10 citations**
- **Does the Digitalization of the Book Industry Reduce Its Environmental Impact?**
M. Sahli, J. Bieser et al. · *Cleaner and Responsible Consumption* · 2026 · **1 citation**
- **Is There a Premium for Legacy Artists? The Death Effect in Exhibition Shows and Auction Transactions**
M. Sahli & A. Cuntz · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2025 · **3 citations**
- **Sustainability in Context: An Evidence-based (Digital) Preservation Lifecycle Investigation**
M. Pennock, M. Sahli & J. Chenoweth · *iPRES 2025, Wellington* · 2025 · **2 citations**
- **Million Dollar Baby — A Primer on Film Finance Practices in the U.S. Movie Industry**
A. Cuntz, A. Muscarnera, P. C. Oguguo & M. Sahli · *Industry & Innovation* · 2024 · **13 citations**
- **Intermediary Liability and Trade in Follow-on Innovation**
A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2023 · **19 citations**

UNDER REVIEW

- **From Digitization to Diffusion: Evidence on the Economic Value of Open Cultural Heritage**
R&R AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS
M. Sahli, J. Bieser, J. Chenoweth, J. Suckling, J. Love, E. Lin, M. Martens, M. Pennock & U. Pottgiesser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Gender Gaps in Museum Exhibitions and Art Auctions: Evidence from Linked Exhibition and Auction Records** **SUBMITTED TO JOURNAL OF ECONOMIC BEHAVIOR & ORGANIZATION**
L. J. Noll & M. Sahli · *ACEI Working Paper Series* · 2026 · **1 citation**
- **Elvis' Ghost or Digital Replica? Publicity Rights and Integrated IP Strategy**
SUBMITTED TO STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT JOURNAL
A. Cuntz, B. Lutes & M. Sahli · *WIPO Economic Working Paper No. 89* · 2025
- **Evaluating the Sustainability of National Libraries: A Life Cycle Sustainability Assessment**
SUBMITTED TO NPJ HERITAGE SCIENCE
M. Sahli et al. · *Working paper* · 2025

WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Open by Design: An Empirical Comparison of National Library Digitization Strategies on Wikimedia Commons** **IN PREPARATION**
M. Sahli, E. Bertacchini & J. Bieser · *Working paper* · 2026

BOOK CHAPTERS, DISSERTATION & OTHER OUTPUT

- **Empirical Essays on the Economics of Creative Industries** **PHD DISSERTATION**
M. Sahli · *University of Neuchâtel* · 2023
- **The Covid-19 Impact on Artistic Income: Evidence from Germany** **BOOK CHAPTER**
A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *CEPR Press & Covid Economics 82* · 2022 · **17 citations**

● TEACHING

- 2026 - **HES-SO — Haute École de Gestion Genève**
Economics of Innovation (guest lectures)
- 2025 - **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH), Business School**
Entrepreneurial Law (Master) · Digitalrecht (Bachelor) · Data Literacy (continuing education); lecturer and module coordination
★ **Student evaluation 5.25 / 6 (6 = best possible score)**

2025	EPFL, College of Management MGT-404 Management of Intellectual Property (Master) ★ Student evaluation 1.24 / 4 (1 = best possible score)
ongoing	BFH Supervision of bachelor's and master's theses, practice projects and applied R&D projects

● SELECTED TALKS

11/2026	DINAcon — Conference for Digital Sustainability, Kongresszentrum Bern · Bern, Switzerland SCHEDULED
11/2026	Swiss National Library · Bern, Switzerland SCHEDULED
10/2026	DUN — Dachverband der Urheber- und Nachbarrechtsnutzer · Switzerland SCHEDULED
06/2026	European Academy of Management Annual Conference (EURAM 2026) · Kristiansand, Norway SCHEDULED
06/2025	International Conference on Cultural Economics (ACEI) · Rotterdam, Netherlands (3 papers)
06/2025	IP-Network BFH — IP and Economics · Bern, Switzerland
04/2025	BFH sounding board meeting · Bern, Switzerland
06/2024	DRUID24 · Nice, France
03/2024	EPFL STIP Research Retreat · Crans-Montana, Switzerland
02/2024	Cultural Economics Online Seminars — symposium on causal inference in cultural economics · online
10/2023	Unlocking value from digital heritage collections — invited panellist (Wikimedia Italy) · Turin, Italy
07/2023	SERCI Annual Congress · Bournemouth, UK
03/2023	Digital Economy Workshop, University of Lausanne · Lausanne, Switzerland
11/2022	WIPO internal research seminar · Geneva, Switzerland
09/2022	SERCI Annual Congress, University of Colorado Law School · Boulder, USA
09/2022	European Policy for Intellectual Property Conference (EPIP), University of Cambridge · Cambridge, UK
07/2022	Urban Creativity Conference, University of Lisbon · Lisbon, Portugal
06/2022	Munich Summer Institute (MSI) · Munich, Germany
04/2022	Cultural Economics Online Seminar · online
09/2021	EPIP PhD Workshop · Madrid, Spain
07/2021	ACEI Young Researchers Workshop, 21st Conference on Cultural Economics · Lille, France
06/2021	IRENE PhD Meeting, University of Neuchâtel · Neuchâtel, Switzerland
03/2021	IP & Innovation PhD Virtual Seminar, University of Lausanne · online
12/2020	Research Workshop, Copenhagen Business School · Copenhagen, Denmark
11/2020	PhD Seminar Series, University of Southern Denmark · Odense, Denmark
09/2020	PhD Seminar Series, ETH Zurich (Law and Economics, Prof. S. Bechtold) · Zurich, Switzerland
06/2020	First Econ Online Seminar, WIPO · Geneva, Switzerland
10/2018	Reinventing the world — the power of Industry 4.0 · Belgrade, Serbia

● ORGANIZED CONFERENCES & SEMINARS

2025 - 2026	ICT4S 2026 International Conference, Bern University of Applied Sciences Organizing Committee
11/2022	An Industry Practitioners Event on Intellectual Property Rights and U.S. Movie Finance, WIPO Geneva Co-organizer

● POLICY WORK

2018	Value of IP in the New Economy. WTO TRIPS submission (IP/C/W/648) · Co-author
2017	Intellectual Property & Innovation: Inclusive Innovation and MSME Trade. WTO TRIPS submission (IP/C/W/635) · Co-author

● GRANTS & AWARDS

2026	Swisscom study — “From Data to Action: Do Digital GHG Management Tools Drive Real-World Emission Reductions?” (CHF 32,409)
2021	Best Paper Award, Young Researchers Workshop, 21st International Conference on Cultural Economics, Lille (USD 500)
2020	Travel grant for the study visit at Copenhagen Business School — Commission de Recherche FNS / Fonds des Donations, University of Neuchâtel

● ACADEMIC SERVICE

Peer review	Journal of Cultural Economics (2) · European Journal of Law and Economics · Humanities and Social Sciences Communications · Socio-Economic Review · Economics of Governance (1)
Memberships	Society for Economic Research on Copyright Issues (2022–2024) · European Policy for Intellectual Property (2022–2024) · Association for Cultural Economics International (until 2027)

● DOCTORAL COURSES

Workshop and lecture series in law and economics — ETH Zurich and the Universities of Lucerne, St. Gallen and Zurich (Prof. E. Ash, Prof. S. Bechtold, Prof. G. Hertig, Prof. S. Lüchinger, Prof. A. Stremitzer), Spring 2021

Obtaining data from the internet: data crawling for research in business and economics — University of Zurich (Prof. C. Peukert, Prof. J. Claussen), Spring 2021

● RESEARCH INTERESTS & SKILLS

Interests	Intellectual property · economics of innovation · industrial organization · economic policy · applied econometrics · creative industries · art markets · sustainability · digitization
Languages	Swiss German (native) · German · English · French
Software	Stata · R · Python (basics) · LaTeX · web crawling

● REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Gaétan de Rassenfosse

EPFL

Dr. Carsten Fink

Chief Economist, WIPO

Prof. Dr. Jan Bieser

Bern University of Applied Sciences

Dr. Alexander Cuntz

Senior Economist, WIPO

E-mail addresses available on request.